

Sri Lanka- All Inclusive Guide

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Final Itinerary

Day	Colombo- Kandy (day)-Kalutara- Mirissa (day)
Day 1 Dec 23 Monday	Catch flight from BOM at 12:15 pm Arrive in Colombo at 15:00 Transfer to your hotel- ITC Ratnadipa (45 mins from the airport) Check-in and freshen up and relax Visit Pettah Floating Market (9 mins by taxi). Here you can witness and also buy local produce and local handicrafts. It is open everyday except Sundays from 8am-10:30 pm Have dinner (refer to eating out guide) Return back to the hotel and spend the night.

Day 2 Dec 24 Tuesday	- Visit the Pinnawala Elephant Orphanage (2.5 hr drive from Colombo) It is open 8:30am- 5:30pm Entrance fee is about 2500 LKR for adults and 1250 LKR for children - Continue driving to Kandy (about 1.5 hr) - Here, you can choose to do 1 or more of the following Both the below are in close proximity - Watch a Cultural show at the Kandy Lake Club – book tickets online or on the spot. Start time is 5pm and ticket is 3500 LKR - Visit the Temple of the Tooth Relic (open everyday from 05:30am-08:00pm). Entrance fee is Rs. 1500 - Both the below are in close proximity Arthurs Seat Kandy Viewpoint (open through, no fee) Kandy lake – free to visit, no set timing. It is recommended to visit at sunset, and to take a boat tour (15 mins- Rs. 1500) Return back to Colombo and have dinner (check eating out guide)
Day 3 Dec 25 Wednesday	- Sleep in, have a leisurely breakfast - Do some shopping at Odel - Visit the Crescat Boulevard or One Galle Face for festive decorations and activities. - Visit Galle Face Green (a 3 min walk- just opposite the hotel) - It is a large seaside park with a lively atmosphere and a great place to try out some Sri Lankan street food (prawn crackers) and enjoy the sunset and dusk. - It is open all through the day and entry is free. - There is a Christmas Day lunch (12pm- 3pm) at Emperors Wok at the Hilton Colombo. It is about Rs. 3300 per person. - There is a Christmas Day Dinner Buffet (7pm onwards) at Graze Kitchen at Hilton Colombo. It is priced at Rs. 4000 per person
Day 4 Dec 26 Thursday	- After breakfast, check out of your hotel and transfer to Avani Kalutara (1.5 hrs drive) - Check in, have lunch and relax by the beach or use the resort's amenities - Spend the evening at Karadiya Bar, the resorts stunning bar offering expertly crafted cocktails, poolside seating and breathtaking ocean views
Day 5 Dec 27 Friday	- Take a day trip to Mirissa (2.5hrs away) to do some whale watching. You are going in the best season to spot the whales! - You will need to reach the Mirissa Harbour at 6 am to head out and watch the whales - On the way back, stop at Galle- - Visit the Galle lighthouse - Spend time at the Galle Fort - Have dinner at the Old Dutch Hospital Shopping Precint (a beautiful restored colonial building with shops, cafes and restaurants). It will be decorated for Christmas. - Have a relaxing night back at the resort
Day 6 Dec 28 Saturday	- Sleep in, have a leisurely breakfast - Those who wish can take part in various water sport activities such as snorkelling, diving, jet skiing, paddle boarding, banana boat rides etc.

	• In the afternoon, visit the Kalutara Bodhiya (15 mins from the resort), a sacred fig tree believed to be a sapling of the original Bodhi tree under which Buddha attained enlightenment. • Or • You can instead choose to visit the Kosgoda Sea Turtle Hatchery (45 mins away from the resort) • In the evening, some of you can explore the nightlife in/around Kalutara
Day 7 Dec 29 Sunday	• Day of relaxation at the resort/by the pool • Spend the evening doing some souvenir shopping around (check souvenir buying guide)
Day 8 Dec 30 Monday	• Check out of your hotel and head directly to the airport (will take you 1.5 hrs) • Catch flight at 4:00pm • Arrive in BOM at 6:40pm

Restaurants In Colombo

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Speciality	Comments	Timings	Price details
Ceylon Curry Club	Sri Lankan	Hoppers Sri Lankan rice, prawn curry Devilled chicken Katta Sambol	Has outdoor seating Has live music	11am- 10:30 pm	
Breeze Barracuda	Multicuisine-Asian Fusion	Great cocktails	Has outdoor seating, live music More known for having a drink with the sea view. Food is average	11am-10pm	
One Galle Face	Multi-cuisine options available	Restaurants: - Manhattan Fish Market - Pastamania Sri Lanka - Dampa Seafood Sri Lanka	Mall having several restaurant options	Most restaurants close by 9:30 pm	
Ministry of Crab	Seafood	Crab	Reservation required	12pm-10:30pm	LKR 5000 per person
Nuga Gama	Sri Lankan	Sri Lankan curry, hoppers, pol sambol	Situated in Colombo Grand hotel	7pm-10:30 pm Sat and sun also open 12-2:30pm	LKR 5000 per person
The Lagoon	Seafood	Choose live seafood and choose what style you want it cooked.	Situated in Colombo Grand hotel Reservations required	12-2:30pm 6pm-12 am	LKR 5000 per person
King of the Mambo	Cuban	Fresh seafood	Situated in Galle Face Hotel, has outdoor seating, latin music,	5pm-2am	LKR 5000 per person

Restaurants In Kandy

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Speciality	Comments	Timings	Price details
Theva Cuisine	Sri Lankan, European, Fusion	Great cocktails Cashew curry Seafood platter	Has outdoor seating	8am-10pm	LKR 5000 per person
Devon Restaurant	Sri Lankan	Rice Box Traditional Milk tea	Over 2 floors, very popular, people are expected to leave once they finish a meal	7:30am- 7pm	
Royal Bar and Hotel	Sri Lankan	Fish cakes Chicken curry Prawn curry Great cocktails	Old world charm, good place to catch a drink Has live performances	7am-11pm	
The Empire Cafe	Small eats	Spring rolls, potato wedges, mac and cheese	Has outdoor seating	9am- 5pm	
Vito Wood Fired Pizza	Italian	Pizzas and pastas	Has outdoor seating	12-09:30pm	

Restaurants In Kalutara

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Speciality	Comments	Timings	Price details
King Bee Restaurant	Seafood	Fresh seafood and fried rice	2 mins away from the beach; 3 min drive from the Avani Resort	10 am – 11 pm	
Red Lobster Tours and Restaurant	Seafood	Seafood platter, garlic butter prawns, seafood fired rice	6 min walk from Avani Resort	11 am – 11 pm	LKR 5000 per person
Sajee Restaurant	Sri Lankan	Chicken Kottu, veg kottu, sting hoppers, chicke curry	Every day a large selection of different and fresh curries.	8 am – 10 pm Opens at 10:30 am on Sunday	LKR 2000 per person
Green Lobster Waskaduwa Seafood Restaurant	Seafood	Fresh seafood- jumbo prawns, calamari	Feet in sand dining (tables on the beach)	11 am – 10 pm	
Nadee Indian Restaurant	Indian	Curries, biryanis		11 am – 9 pm	
Olive Mate	Italian	Pizzas and pasta		10:30 am – 10:30 pm	LKR 2000 per person

Popular local dishes

- **Sri Lanka Rice and Curry** (and papad)- the quintessential dish of the island and usually is eaten at lunchtime.
- **Fish ambul thiyal** (sour fish curry)- The fish is cut into cubes, then sauteed in a blend of spices including black pepper, cinnamon, turmeric, garlic, pandan leaves and curry leaves and the most important ingredient is dried goraka, a small fruit responsible for giving the fish a sour flavor.
- **Kottu (also, kottu roti)**- it's made with a type of roti known as godamba roti (a flat, crispy bread).the kottu chef will fry and chop the roti with a selection of ingredients you choose.
- **Kukul mas curry (chicken curry)**- Spices like fennel seeds, cardamom, cloves and cinnamon sticks are tempered in hot oil before being combined with chicken and spices like chili powder, curry powder, turmeric, pandan leaves, lemongrass and curry leaves.
- **Parippu (dhal curry)**- he most common curry in all of Sri Lankan cuisine
- **Lamprais**- a combination of meat, rice and sambol chili sauce, wrapped into a banana leaf packet and steamed. The rice is cooked with meat stock – usually a combination of different meats like beef, pork or lamb – that's infused with cardamom, clove and cinnamon. A scoop of rice is placed in the center of a banana leaf, along with the mixed meat curry, two frikkadels (Dutch-style beef balls), blachan (a shrimp paste) and a starch or vegetable, usually either ash plantain or brinjals.
- **Hoppers (appa or appam)**- Hoppers are the Sri Lankan answer to the pancake. The batter is made from a slightly fermented concoction of rice flour, coconut milk, sometimes coconut water and a hint of sugar.
- **Polos (green jackfruit curry)**- The fruit is sliced into bite-sized chunks and boiled until soft.It's then cooked with onions, garlic, ginger and spices like mustard seeds, turmeric, chili powder, roasted curry powder, pandan leaves and curry leaf sprigs. The final step is to add coconut milk and simmer to reduce most of the liquid, leaving all the beautiful flavors within the cubes of jackfruit.
- **Wambatu moju (eggplant/brinjals pickle)**- Served mostly with rice and curries, wambatu moju is an extremely flavorful candied eggplant (brinjals) pickle
- **Gotu kola sambol (pennywort salad)**- Gotu kola (known in English as Asiatic pennywort) is a medicinal herb in Asia. It's shredded into slivers, then combined with shallots, tomatoes, fresh grated coconut and chili and seasoned with a dressing of salt, pepper and lemon juice.
- **Pol Sambol (coconut relish)**- Pol sambol, which might also be called fresh coconut relish, is a simple blend of finely grated coconut, red onions, dried whole chilies or chili powder, lime juice, salt and Maldiv fish (if available). The ingredients are diced or ground, then combined in a bowl. It goes well with rice and curry, pol roti (coconut roti), a hot paratha, string hoppers or even just scooped up with slices of bread
- **Pol Roti**- have a similar taste to naan. Served warm, they are made with wheat flour and scraped coconut
- **Ceylon Tea**- The tea is usually served black with milk and kithul jaggery - a cube of brown refined sugar
- **Kola Kanda**- Kola Kana is a traditional green, herby concoction that is believed to help digestion, enhance your immune system and reduce cholesterol levels. This age-old energy boost can be served in a bowl or glass and is almost like a herbal porridge
- **Toddy and Arrack**- 'Toddy' is a sharp local alcoholic drink made in the first fermenting stages of the sap of palm trees. 'Arrack' is a further fermented and refined version of 'Toddy.'

- **Asmi-** Milk is added to rice flour, which is continuously kneaded. Later, cinnamon leaves are squeezed into a cup of coconut milk, which is used to make the batter. Its then deep fried in oil and garnished with treacle syrup.

Mobile Connectivity while in Sri Lanka

There are 3 main SIM Card providers in Sri Lanka, but **I would recommend Dialog** for better coverage

- The best place to buy a sim card is at the airport kiosks
- Expect to pay 1,800 LKR for a Dialog Sim which came with 30 GB of data with a validity period of 30 days.
- Even if you do not purchase an international roaming plan for your current India number, remember to activate roaming so that you receive messages (important for things like OTPs).

Emergency Numbers

Here are few numbers to keep handy while in Sri Lanka

- 118/119: Police
- 110: Ambulance
- 011-2691111: Accident Service-General Hospital, Colombo

Important Places Around Your Hotels

Colombo

- **Convenience stores**
 - [Keels One Galleface Shopping Mall](#) (4 min walk from your hotel)
 - Open 9 am – 10 pm
- **Pharmacy**
 - [Healthguard Pharmacy One Galleface Shopping Mall](#) (4 min walk from the hotel)
 - Open 10 am – 10 pm
- **Hospital:**
 - [General Hospital OPD](#) (14 min taxi drive from the hotel)
 - Open 24 hrs

Kalutara

- **Convenience store**
 - [Aprico Supercentre](#) (5 min drive from the hotel)
 - Open 8:30 am – 10 pm
- **Pharmacy**
 - [CFC Healthcare Pharmacy](#) (10 min drive from the hotel)
 - Open 8:30 am – 10 pm

- **Hospital**
 - [Teaching Hospital Kalutara Nagoda](#) (11 min taxi ride)
 - Open 24 hrs

Recommended things to buy/carry

- Travel Insurance- Recommendation- TATA AIG
- Caps
- Umbrellas
- Mosquito Repellent
- Travel adaptors- you need a power plug travel adapter for sockets type D, G and M in Sri Lanka.
- Doctors prescriptions/travel prescriptions for medicines (except over the counter meds)

Common Phrases

Sri Lankan Word	Meaning in English
ayubowan	Hello
Kohomada sahpa sah neepa	How are you?
Bohoma istouti	Thank you
Ovou	Yes
Nehe	No
Samaava	Sorry
Ayubowan	Goodbye

Recommended Apps

- Google Translate
- Google Maps

Regarding Foreign Currency

- The official currency of **Sri Lanka** is the Sri Lankan Rupee, which can be divided into 100 cents. “SLR” is the most commonly used abbreviation, but the official currency code is “LKR.
- Sri Lankan coins come in denominations of 1, 2, 5, 10, 25, and 50 cents. Sri Lankan banknotes come in denominations of 10, 20, 50, 100, 200, 500, 1000, and 5000 rupees.

- Credit and debit cards are widely accepted in Sri Lanka, even in smaller towns. Visa and MasterCard are the most commonly accepted cards. AmEx is also accepted, but to a lesser extent. That said, it's still a good idea to carry some cash with you just in case.
- Cash would be especially needed for entrance fees to sightseeing spots and for smaller restaurants/grocery shops.

What to buy as souvenirs and from where?

Type of souvenir	Where to buy
Ceylon Tea	Colombo Mlesna Tea Centre
Ceylon cinnamon	Supermarkets
Sri Lankan Jaggery	Supermarkets
Batik	Kandy Jayamali Batiks Studio in Kandy market Colombo Laksala
Sarongs	Colombo Laksala
Gems including moonstone carvings	There are several gem shops in Colombo and Kandy Colombo Prestige gems Gamini gem and jewellery Kandy Kahandawela Kalutara Moonlight Gems and Jewellery
Local brands apparel shopping	Colombo Crescat Boulevard Odel
Ayurveda beauty products	Colombo Spa Ceylon
Sri Lankan saris	Colombo Barefoot
Typical souvenirs- fridge magnets,	Colombo

postcard,	Laksala
Traditional handicrafts- sea shell and coconut items, handcrafted elephants, stone art	Colombo Laksala (state owned) Lakpahana Kalutara Tantra Art Gallery
Dumbara Mats and Canes Boxes	Colombo Laksala

Thank You!

Thank you for trusting us with the opportunity to plan your vacation!

We hope your trip is filled with unforgettable memories and special moments together.

Remember, we're always here to assist you—before, during, and even after your journey. Just a call or message away!

Bon Voyage By Marina - 86000-15316